

Medford School Committee Meeting Notes

Monday, January 24, 2022: 6:30 PM

To be held at the Howard Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall.

Also presented on Zoom:

Join Zoom Meeting

<https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/j/99048068111>

6:39PM Roll Call for Attendance of Members and the Student Representatives

Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Sharon hays, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Breanna Lungo-Koehn: 7 present/0 absent

Gabby Puccio is student representative but not yet logged on.

Salute the Flag

Consent Agenda

- Approval of Bills/Payrolls
- Regular School Committee Meeting Minutes, 1.10.2022

Motion to approve: Paul Ruseau/Kathy Kreatz: all in favor: 7/0

Consent agenda approved.

Report of the Superintendent

Superintendent's Updates and Comments - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent

Today is January 24th, which the United Nations deemed in 2018, as the International Day of Education. The declaration called for free and compulsory elementary education to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education for all” by 2030. The 2022 theme is: “Changing Course, Transforming Education.” The United Nations resolution highlighted the importance of the fundamental right for everyone to education, to help to build a more sustainable, inclusive and peaceful world.

On behalf of Project Bread, they have asked us to encourage our families to apply for critical SNAP benefits. There have been policy changes made to SNAP, and we hope that our families will take the time to check it out at GettingSNAP.org. SNAP helps households meet nutritional and dietary needs, enables households to purchase food that is healthy and culturally appropriate, and supports low-wage households.

I would like to add my congratulations to “Ms. Ginny” Eugenia Chitopoulos, longtime school lunch monitor at the Brooks Elementary School, on the joyous occasion of her 90th Birthday, last week on January 19th! Ms. Ginny has the energy of an elementary-aged student and she is a bright light and busy bee at the Brooks ES. She is a beloved member of the school community and we appreciate her willingness to support our students.

Please note: Wednesday, January 26th is the Zoom Monthly Support Meeting for Parents & Caregivers with children dealing with Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD) and related disorders from 6:30 - 7:30 PM.

Also, on Wednesday, and I know that both Nurse Avery and Mr. Murphy will be providing a more detailed Covid-19 update shortly, but I did want to remind everyone that Medford High will be hosting a vaccine clinic from 12:30 PM - 6 PM, featuring both the Covid 19 vaccines and flu shots. While Covid vaccines are limited to staff and students, the flu vaccines are state supplied and available for anyone including uninsured adults. My Friday message included the registration links and they are located on the school blog as well.

Thursday, January 27th, the Medford Family Network presents a zoom meeting with the topic: Keeping Kids Safe on the Internet. This is a training for parents/caregivers of children 8 years old and younger and will be held from 7:30 - 8:30 PM. Please register with the MFN. **Additionally, the Medford Family Network is seeking donations of diapers sizes 5 & 6 as well as wipes.** If you are able to assist, please contact MFN at (781) 393-2106.

After a three week shut down due to Covid-19 concerns, I am happy to report that the Mustangs are back on the court, which includes our middle school basketball teams, and back on the ice as well. Additionally, the gymnastics team and indoor track team have returned to competition. **Good luck to all of our winter sports teams.**

The new beautiful Charlotte and William Bloomberg Medford Public Library is open and is busy scheduling all types of in-person and zoom events for all ages. They just announced the 2022 Teen Reading Challenge for students in grades 6-12. For students who might be interested, please contact Nicole at the Library at (781) 475-5735.

Medford High School and MSBA Application Deadline Update: Central Administration will present on the recently announced application windows for the Massachusetts School Building Authority repair project that opens this Friday, January 28, 2022. The administration plans to consider possible statements of interest (SOI) about their two programs — the Accelerated Repair Program (ARP) (which involves repairing specific sections of schools) or the Core Program (which involves building a completely new school). The respective deadlines are March 25th and April 29th. This important work will require the collaboration and support of many stakeholders to be successful. A report later this evening will provide more information.

In closing, Chinese New Year 2022, also known as Lunar New Year and the Spring Festival, begins Tuesday, February 1st. It is the year of the Tiger and those born during this year are predicted to be

brave, competitive, unpredictable, and confident. We express our wishes of good health and happiness to all of our Asian families and friends who celebrate this 16 day festival.

Introduction to the Equity Process - The Equity Process, a firm hired to conduct the Equity Audit of Medford Public Schools, will present the scope of work for MPS. - Ms. Cyndi Weekes-Bradley, CEO of The Equity Process, and Superintendent of Schools Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent.

[Link to Slides:](#)

It is not a scientific method by any means. It is looking at the data very closely and allowing the data to write the script/narrative. We are interested in meeting with SC members if you are interested. We are interviewing the leadership team. We look at the implicit bias tools you are using and determining if there are different tools you should be using. What might the experience look like for all students in Medford? How do we ensure and embrace the notion that students of all minority populations feel safe and are living their vision of success. I was born in Barbados, a small country that has 100% literacy. How do we not have that in our country?

Questions:

Paul Ruseau: Thank you for the presentation. I certainly understand why HR is the first step but is it too soon to know what the next step will be?

Cyndi Weekes-Bradley: The next step is up to the Superintendent. Given it is a large district, HR was the logical first step to figure out what needs to be in place for 21st century learning.

Jenny Graham: When you say the scope of this initial piece is HR, what does that mean to you?

Cyndi Weekes-Bradley: We need to look at how Medford defines Human Resources? Hiring/retention; mission of the school and mission of Human resources. We ask questions during focus groups.

Jenny Graham: To Superintendent Edouard-Vincent, how has HR been defined in terms of this Equity Audit.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: A challenge we face in Medford is the difficulty to recruit/retain diverse candidates. We are looking at current practices of where we are getting our candidates. The retention piece is important. Often BIPOC staff stay only one or two years. Trying to unpack why that is? Is there something that makes Medford less attractive? As a starting point, it is not who is or isn't doing something in HR. It is improving practices on recruitment and retention. In light of the pandemic, we decided the focus should be on HR and not having consultants in and out of schools during the surge.

Jenny Graham: Was the Racial Equity Task Force involved in setting the scope of the audit?

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: The Racial Equity Task Force was initially involved in wanting the audit. Because of the surge, the admin decided to bring the Equity Audit.

Cyndi Weekes-Bradley; We are starting this week and will have the report in May at the latest.

Paul Ruseau: Will we get recommendations even if they are not the most solvable? We can hire candidates of all diverse backgrounds but they will leave to go to neighboring towns to make more money. I want to hear it even if it puts us in an uncomfortable position.

Cyndi Weekes-Bradley: I involve the children in all of the stakeholder work.

Mea Mustone: Will the recommendations given to the Equity Process be sent to the rules committee to set policy?

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: We will give a presentation with what the results are and what the feasible next steps will be. You will have it before the end of the school year.

COVID Update -Assistant Superintendent of Finance & Operations David Murphy and Avery Hines ([link to health memo](#)) Director of Health Services will report on operational updates and pending COVID shifts in the Medford Public Schools.

We are looking at the week of Feb. 14 to administer in school vaccinations and are working with principals to identify space. We also will have an at school portion for staff.

During our Jan. 10th meeting, Ms. Hines and I discussed with you that variables of the pandemic were changing and we would need to look at making changes to the program. DESE has since announced distribution of large volume of at home tests. Marks a shift. During this last surge, we have seen the challenge. We transitioned to PCR testing due to the surge but it is not sustainable. We went back to pooled testing today. We intend to continue with Pooled testing through february but will join the DESE program to acquire at home tests. We need to consider how to step down from our current testing program. As we transition, we will reduce the contact tracing effort. The Boards of Health ceased contact tracing this last summer but we continued it in our schools. We think that was the right thing to do at the time. We didn't do test and stay because we felt our program provided greater protection. Today, a very small number of students could test because of previous exposure. So it makes us question if it is the best use of time. The equation changes again when we get the at home tests to distribute. End of Feb; we will do diagnostic testing on the symptomatic. We will still be connected to BROAD so that we are not completely reliant on the at home tests.

Ms. Hines; you got it right.

Paul Ruseau: I appreciate the plans for future weeks.

Dave Murphy: All contingent on declining rates of infection.

Paul Ruseau: I think it is a fantasy that the state has all these tests. This week's memo stated PCR testing this week - was that an error?

Dave Murphy: Yes. It is still PCR but administered in a pool. Students will need to opt into the program to receive the rapid tests. One of our concerns is that if we keep the surveillance testing open, people will have no incentive to opt in?

Sharon Hays: High Needs students???

Dave Murphy: Contact tracing will be stepped down but we have made a strategic plan to continue to the contact tracing for more vulnerable students (K, EL, Special Needs).

Sharon Hays: The infographic was helpful but I wanted to ask for a clarification on that: what is day one? Day 0 is the day you test positive.

Avery Hines: Day zero is determined after a conversation with the nurse: symptoms may have been in place. Nurses send out more detailed timeline to each student.

Sharon Hays: Can this information be sent home in the backpack?

Dave Murphy: It will happen soon. We knew the variables were changing so we didn't want to send it out too prematurely. Now that it is becoming more settled, we will be able to send it home.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: In general, if it can link to the website as well as the information is constantly changing.

Jenny Graham: In Feb. when we shift the contact tracing, parents should not expect a call saying they were a close contact. The communication will stop for the most part and instead, students will have access to at home tests and be able to test on the spot?

Dave Murphy: That is correct. Communication to close contacts will not come after the week of Feb. 2 except with high needs population. We have been contact tracing with vaccinated students but that will need to stop. Every single person has a responsibility to monitor for symptoms.

Jenny Graham: People who have been excluded from school because of being a close contact have generally not tested positive.

Dave Murphy: You are right: in school transmission is extremely rare but the aftermath of missing school is much worse.

Jenny Graham: Every time there is a change in the program, each family assesses their level of risk. Any data points or messages of clarification will be helpful to some. For those who are concerned, I do want to try to address their concerns. In the aggregate, the effectiveness of the vaccines is there but it would be helpful to know the level of breakthrough infections among our students would be helpful for families to know. I also wonder about the media reports on the legislature sending improved quality masks for students. Are there masks coming for kids?

Dave Murphy: I don't think we know for certainty. We are adjusting our testing program but we are not changing our safety protocols. Students will still have access to tests.

Kathy Kreatz: Is there going to be an every week distribution of the rapid tests? In school?

Dave Murphy: Ms. Hines will be attending the DESE meeting on Wednesday and we will find out more details but we know we will receive our staff supply of tests for staff this week and for students in the next two weeks. It is unclear whether the shipment will have our student count or for whom have provided consent?

Kathy Kreatz : Is there a new consent form?

Dave Murphy: Yes - it is a DESE Form.

Midyear Update on Execution of the Strategic Plan - Superintendent Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, will provide a mid-year update on the status of key initiatives.

Jenny Graham: We approved the Strategic plan last spring and there was a lot of discussion of our mission and vision statement and we spoke of returning to it this year. Where do we stand on this?

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: We can definitely start that soon.

Enrichment Program Overview - Camp Mustang to be offered February and April vacation in addition to Enrichment After School Programs K-12. Report presented by Assistant Superintendent of Elementary Education Suzanne Galusi, Assistant Superintendent of Secondary Education Dr. Peter Cusing, and Director of Pupil Services Joan Bowen.

Suzanne Galusi/Joan Bowen: This is an offering for students free of cost. We are so excited about the many fun activities our staff have planned. It is offered for two days, the same lessons are offered each day so if a student would like to do two days, we suggest they sign up for two different activities.

Peter Cushing: We will provide an update on extended day learning opportunities at the next meeting.

Peter Cushing: Is it covered by ARPA Funding?

Suzanne Galusi: Yes and we got reimbursed \$42K for last years Camp Mustang.

Melanie McLaughlin: For students with disabilities?

Joan Bowen: We have paraprofessionals who signed up for work those days to add extra support. We also have accommodations on the form and we will also have a nurse available.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: Is there a rush to sign up? Are there unlimited entries?

Peter Cushing: Certain activities (such as Metal Fabrication) may not fit as many students as others.

Melanie McLaughlin: Will the information also go to the out of district families?

Joan Bowen: Yes

Kathy Kreatz: I am excited to hear about it and happy to hear so many staff are able to work.

Budget Update - Assistant Superintendent of Finance & Operations David Murphy will provide an update on the Medford Public Schools budget.

[LINK TO SLIDES](#)

I defer to the SC as to whether 6 COW meetings are the best way to present the budget this year? What you heard over and over during the budget process, is we present our needs to make the Strategic plan possible but we are aware that we need to adapt accordingly. As administrators in the district, we will act in good faith. We have an obligation to advocate zealously but yet work with what is appropriated by the City government.

Melanie McLaughlin: I am wondering what the proposed process will be. We had put a motion to start scheduling in January.

Dave Murphy: We need to decouple the hiring process and the budget process. We have held the posting of positions that in some cases until the process moves along and it is putting us at a disadvantage with other districts. It is always the case that we could post and hire and then have a budget process. There are presumptions we can make to make us more competitive. I am not recommending a specific process - it is your decision- we will present whatever you ask for. The repetition of administrators showing up and saying a script doesn't always reflect the budgeting priorities. This is an opportunity for someone to suggest a process. There is a limit on what we can debate when 80% is tied up in CBAs. If there are components of the budget you want us to present, I believe that should be the focus of our conversation. Last year we did late April. If we do it earlier in March, there will be a lot of unanswered questions at the state level.

Melanie: I recommend a motion for a COW for what the process should be? I don't know how to move it forward without more conversation.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: We don't have a number yet.

Dave: I don't think we don't know what the budget process is - what I would like is an opportunity to hear from the committee a set of priorities. We want to make sure we present a budget that is tied to the SC recommendations.

Paul Ruseau: I do want to stop having the principals and directors putting on a dog and pony show. We are expected to serve the goals that the supt. is expected to meet.

Dave Murphy: I agree but I do believe you need a forum to ask questions. We need to hear from you what you would like built into next year's budget. We need to find out how we want it organized, what the contingencies are.

Paul Ruseau: I want to know that spending on band and other activities is equitable with sports.

Jenny Graham: there have been instances where admin have sought our input and you use it and come back to us with a presentation. We all need to individually tell you what is important to us, there will be duplication across members. I am a fan of your collecting information individually. Maybe we will cancel the second meeting in March and make it a budget meeting. I do want to hear a cohesive message from the superintendent of what direction the district is going in. We start with one night of you stating what the priorities are.

Dave Murphy: Late March would be appropriate understanding the variables with state and local funding.

Sharon Hays: Can we post "anticipated openings" in March?

Dave Murphy: Yes. March would be the start of recruitment season. It is not uncommon for smaller districts to wait on it.

Melanie McLaughlin: I definitely hear that six meetings at several hours each is a lot. How can we address transparency for the budget for the community? Did we pass a motion to start the process in January?

Dave: I believe this conversation we are having now is what was asked for in the motion. We will build the form, distribute it to all of you and then collect the information to have something to present to you in early March.

Paul: Transparency is very important. Our documents are not easy to read. I believe the public would be happier with clearer documents than too many meetings.

Dave Murphy: Accessibility is important. Packaging it in a more digestible way will make it more transparent.

Jenny Graham: For the administration to stop with the narratives and address the questions we ask each year. Like why are there two gym teachers at the Missituk? Why do we give the same office supply budgets across the board when enrollments vary. It is important that we are interested in telling a story about how we are going to spend their money thoughtfully. The quality of the information can improve with the collective work of the organization.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: Is there a motion on the floor.

Melanie McLaughlin: No second we are all set.

Summer School Fees - Assistant Superintendent of Finance & Operations David Murphy will respond to Committee inquiry regarding Summer School Fee waivers.

This is a resolution regarding summer school fees considerations and the impact of waiving those fees. We don't know how many students would qualify in each subgroup. If we look at last years numbers, \$250 per course. EL subgroup - fees were waived for 15/17 students. Similar waivers for students with disabilities. Maximum liability: \$47,000. It would most likely never be that high. Students are never charged for something that is on their IEP. There is no recommendation against doing this. I am not concerned about absorbing it this year but I don't know three or four years from now. The 45 day timeline will not work. It could be disruptive to getting students to finish the school year.

Melanie McLaughlin: Did we get a copy of this and the budget document?

Dave Murphy: They were not in the packet but were distributed this afternoon.

Melanie: I would love to know the total number of students enrolled.

Peter Cushing: 96 students/160 enrollments

Melanie McLaughlin: As for the 45 day notification, I would like to amend it to whatever the Supt. feels it should be reasonable to notify students for needs of retention?

Dave Murphy: It would be difficult to fashion a one size fits all approach with this as it is a student by student basis.

Melanie McLaughlin: Perhaps a process could be created.

Marice Edouard-Vincent : I can get that specific information at the high school when parents are notified. Some students think they are ok but right at the end of the year, their grade goes down. I will work on getting that information for you.

Mea Mustone: Do engagement specialists have a better grip on attendance?

Dave Murphy: This is not the month to gauge our attendance. We have an additional Eng. Specialist in the high school to work on attendance as well as other things.

Motion on the floor: remove the 45 days to notify students of summer school but would like to develop a plan for process and communication of retention efforts.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: Is it a motion to add it to number 7?
(no vote taken)

MSBA Application - Assistant Superintendent of Finance & Operations David Murphy will report on Medford High School and MSBA Application Deadline Update: The central administration will present on the recently announced application windows for the Massachusetts School Building Authority repair project windows opening January 28, 2022 and the administration plans to consider possible statements of interest through either or both of the Core Program or Accelerated Repair Program.

Core program: new building

Accelerated repair program: windows would qualify. Boiler would potentially qualify.

In the resolution this evening, it will direct you to let us know which program to apply for in March? In conjunction with that, there will be a formation of a flagship committee to come up with a decision. This commits us to making progress on this issue.

Presentations of the Public (not to begin before 7:00 pm)

No emails to be read.

Continued Business

1. Whereas students and families have been charged more than \$200 per class for summer remediation and credit recovery,

And whereas students enrolled in summer remediation and credit recovery are disproportionately more vulnerable subgroups, including economically disadvantaged students, students with disabilities and English learners,

Be it Resolved Medford Public Schools will no longer charge students identified as belonging in the subgroups, economically disadvantaged, English Learners and students with disabilities for remediation programming and credit recovery during summer programming and the academic year commencing June 1, 2022.

Be it further resolved that all students requiring credit remediation to prevent retention be notified in writing through the United States postage system and email 45 days before the last day of school.

- *Tabled from 1.10.2022*
- *Submitted by Member Melanie McLaughlin and Member Mea Mustone*

Melanie McLaughlin: amendment to remove the 45 days.

Be it further that a communication policy will be created to notify caregivers of need for credit remediation.

Get wording

7/0 paper passes

VIII. New Business

1. The Bullying Prevention and Intervention Plan will be reviewed by the Rules, Policy, and Equity Subcommittee for recommended updates.

- *Offered by Member Paul Ruseau*
- *Second by Mea Mustone*
- *7/0 paper passes*

2. Policy BEDB - AGENDA CREATION AND FORMAT FOR REGULAR MEETINGS OF THE SCHOOL COMMITTEE will be amended by the insertion of the following text immediately following "New Business"

Motion to waive reading: Paul Ruseau/Jenny Graham: 7/0 paper passes

[Items on the agenda will be formatted as follows:

<New Business Item Number> - Offered by Member(s) <name(s)>

<text of motion or resolution>

Meeting Date Requested: <meeting date member asked to have this item on the agenda>

Submitted Date: <date submitted>

New Business Item Number will be formatted as: <year> - <number>. <year> will be the calendar year when the item was received by the Superintendent. New Business Item Number will be determined by the Superintendent's office and the number will reset to 1 for items received on or after January 1.

The Submitted Date is not the Meeting Date Requested but rather the date the item was emailed to the Superintendent and Chair. It is not uncommon for an item to be submitted well in advance of the actual meeting where the item is to be placed on the agenda, and items submitted may not be for the next meeting.

Example 1:

On August 21, 2021, Member Robert Smith submits a resolution for the meeting scheduled for October 1, 2021. The Superintendent determines this is the 114th item submitted in 2021:

2021-114 - Offered by Member Smith

Be it resolved that ...

Meeting Date Requested: October 1, 2021

Submitted Date: August 21, 2021

Example 2:

On January 1, 2022, Member Francis Roberts submits a resolution for the meeting scheduled for February 1, 2022. The Superintendent determines this is the 1st item submitted in 2022:

2022-1 - Offered by Member Roberts

Be it resolved that ...

Meeting Date Requested: February 1, 2022

Submitted Date: January 1, 2022]

- *Offered by Member Paul Ruseau*

This is an update to the renovations made last year. This allows us to do what happens on City Council and all legislative bodies, it attaches a number to it. Makes it difficult to track. The numbering system matches what City Council uses: Year/number assigned by supt. Office as they receive motions. Exec. Asst. will give the number as it is posted on the agenda. Slight change to the format on the agenda. Additional pieces of information: meeting date requested and date of submission.

9:22; Motion to approve: Jenny Graham/Melanie: 7/0 paper passes

3. Policy BEDB - Agenda Creation and Format for Regular Meetings of the School Committee containing language from Policy BEDH - Public Comment at School Committee Meetings, will be updated to reflect the changes approved in BEDH on January 10, 2022 by this body;

The language “Pursuant to policy BEDH, Public Comment and Presentations of the Public - any resident in the audience may be given permission to speak once on any item on the agenda for up to three (3) minutes. The speaker is expected to keep their comments to the item on the agenda. The speaker must begin their comments by providing their full name and full Medford street address where they reside. Residents may also submit their comments by writing to the Superintendent of Schools prior to the meeting, or by emailing medfordsc@medford.k12.ma.us prior to or during the item on the agenda. Written comments must be kept to a length that allows for them to be read into the record in less than three (3) minutes or the comments will be summarized by the Secretary of the School Committee. A welcoming inclusive community is both a value of the School Committee and an aspirational goal. We ask for your help in achieving this goal and value your perspective. When writing or emailing, please provide this required information: 1) The number and name of the item on the agenda. 2) Your first and last name. 3) Your full Medford street address where you reside. 4) Your question or comment” will be replaced by:

“Pursuant to policy BEDH, Public Comment and Presentations of the Public - any resident in the audience may be given permission to speak once on any item on the agenda for up to three (3) minutes. The speaker is expected to keep their comments to the item on the agenda. The speaker must begin their comments by providing their full name and full Medford street address where they reside. A welcoming, inclusive community is both a value of the School Committee and an aspirational goal. We ask for your help in achieving this goal and value your perspective.” Further, the text “3. The Chair will ask the Vice-Chair, “Are there any other public comments you have received?” “If there are, they will be read.” will be deleted and item four (4) will be renumbered as three (3).

Motion to waive the reading: Paul Ruseau/Melanie

- *Offered by Member Paul Ruseau*

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We changed Public Participation at a previous meeting. This is just a policy that references another policy.

Kathy Kreatz: Are you taking anything out?

Paul Ruseau : On January 10, we voted to remove the SC email.

Melanie McLaughlin: I would move to table this to clarify.

Jenny Graham; There are two parts of this. One: there is an email address they can write to us. It will get auto forwarded to us so we can all read it. The other thing we did was we said we would no longer read all of the emails aloud at the school committee. This is just aligning the policy with what we passed in the last meeting. You can participate in person or on zoom. You are not emailing us during the meeting.

Kathy Kreatz: follow up question: since the community can still write to that email address, is there any way you can email to this email address and it will be received by all members.

Paul Ruseau: Point of information: It is in the policy.

Kathy Kreatz: In the policy but not on the agenda. Even an asterisk with a footnote would be helpful to the community.

Paul Ruseau: Policy BEDH in our policy manual.

Melanie McLaughlin: Part of the issue is that no one has a policy manual. Part of the problem is we are looking at new policies but not comparing it to the old version. Just to be clear there are a number of ways to contact us:

Group email, contact us individually, it may not be read during a meeting. But you can request that we add something to the agenda. Does not mean it automatically will be but there are many ways to move policy requests forward.

Paul Ruseau: We can't have a policy that says this but have the agenda say something else. I am a bit surprised by this conversation. This was just record keeping to clear things up.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: Maybe add a sentence about the email not being read at the meeting.

Jenny Graham: Motion to approve with the amendment but for remainder of school year: please note that your email to the School Committee will be forwarded to all members of the school comm and will not be read into the record as has been in the past.

Motion to approve: 7/0

3. The Rules of the Medford School Committee have traditionally been passed down through the experience of members. While this has served us in the past, it is not best practice to have rules that are not written down for many reasons, such as the ability to bring new members into the committee efficiently, to ensure compliance and enforcement with our rules, agreement on what the rules are, provide transparency to the public on how we operate, to allow us to evolve our rules to improve over time, and provide a clear mechanism to respond to changes in the law that have an effect on our rules.

This has been a multi-year effort to discover best practices from other committees throughout Massachusetts, document the rules we have been operating under even when not written down, and bring these together to create a set of Rules for the Medford School Committee.

With this [Rules document](#), we will have a place to begin. These rules should not be thought of as immutable, but rather offer us a common ground to improve the functioning of the Medford School Committee.

- *Offered by Member Paul Ruseau*

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: Should we table this?

Paul Ruseau: I have been working on this document for three years. I do not want to table it.

Supt. Edouard-Vincent: this is a robust document that is 16 pages long. I will cut down my reports next meeting but we should have a richer conversation.

Paul Ruseau: We have a new member here and we have no instructions as to how to operate.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: I have read it today but I have 20 comments.

Melanie McLaughlin: It is a tremendous amount of work. I did not get to give this the attention it deserves. I am not sure and maybe PR can clarify: there are rules on the website. I would recommend it get moved to the RPE subcommittee.

Motion to move it to Rules policy subcommittee.

Melanie McLaughlin: It gives people opportunity to review document and provides opportunity for RPE to make sure it includes all students.

Paul Ruseau: We all have busy lives and I sent it to members two weeks ago. I am not interested in operating in a lawless situation. I am not interested in sending it back to my own subcommittee. The COW is the only place that makes sense.

Melanie McLaughlin: We are talking about a multiyear effort by whom? Member Ruseau?

Kathy Kreatz: I motion to move it to a COW meeting so all members can participate. Thanks to mr. rousseau for putting it together. If you put three years, it is not appropriate to approve it tonight without our offering feedback and possible amendments.

Melanie McLaughlin: Second

Paul Ruseau: If people can get their schedules out, we can schedule it now.

Melanie McLaughlin: Can we get hard copies of what is provided on the website?

Paul Ruseau: These are not policies - these are rules.

Melanie McLaughlin: Which makes it more necessary for us to have a hard copy.

Paul Ruseau: it will be 100s of pages long. This is why I spent the time.

Melanie McLaughlin: I will volunteer to bring it to a copy store to have copies made.

Mea Mustone: I can't hear it.

Melanie McLaughlin: Since these are policies that reflect rules and vice versa.

Paul Ruseau: It is 350 pages.

Mayor: I will coordinate the date tomorrow.

Paul Ruseau: Tuesday, Feb. 1. 5 to 7.

Dave Murphy: We have a bargaining session on that date.

Jenny: Thursday the 3rd on zoom? 4:00 to 6:00. **A COW meeting to be scheduled for 2/3/2022 from 4:00 to 6:00 to review rules.**

5. Policy BEDC - QUORUM: Four members of the Committee shall constitute a quorum, but a smaller number may meet and adjourn from day to day.

Motion to repeal Quorum.

- *Offered by Member Paul Ruseau*

-

Motion to repeal this policy. Might have existed before open meeting law. Three members is a quorum.

Kathy Kreatz: Are you saying that the old policy is a violation of Open Meeting Law?

Paul Ruseau: The language doesn't exist on MASC anymore. There is no way for members to meet and adjourn.

Melanie McLaughlin: To be clear it is eliminating an outdated policy. Two members can meet for coffee but not three.

Motion to approve: Melanie McLaughlin/Paul Ruseau 7/0 paper passes

6. Policy BDG - SCHOOL ATTORNEY - be referred to the Rules and Policy Subcommittee for recommended updates.

- *Offered by Member Paul Ruseau*

Paul Ruseau: It doesn't look like it has been updated in a long time and it is concerning.

Second: Jenny Graham: 7/0 paper passes

7. Whereas the Medford Public Schools is committed to understanding the needs of our diverse student population and supporting the social-emotional needs of our students;

Whereas the American Academy of Pediatrics, the American Academy of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry, and the Children's Hospital Association have declared a national emergency in child and adolescent mental health;

Whereas the US Surgeon General issued an advisory outlining the devastating impact the COVID-19 pandemic has had and continues to have on the youth mental health crisis that existed prior to the pandemic; and

Whereas the effects of the pandemic have disproportionately affected students from racial and ethnic minorities, students with disabilities, LGBTQ+ students, and students from low income

families;

Therefore, be it resolved that the administration will present at a regular school committee meeting, no later than 03/07/22, a detailed overview of the counseling/mental health supports currently available to students at all levels in the Medford Public Schools, including:

- titles and related job descriptions for positions that provide direct 1:1 or small group counseling to students;
- the number of staff currently in each position and their FTE at each school; current approximate hours spent in direct student contact for counseling (IEP services and non-IEP services);
- number of students at each school who have been referred for school-based individual or small group counseling (IEP and non-IEP);
- approximate number of non-IEP referrals that are on a “waitlist” for school-based counseling;
- number of students at each level who are referred for contracted mental health services outside of MPS;
- and the number of posted positions that remain unfilled.

Be it further resolved that the report will also outline recommended resources and staff required to meet the needs of the MPS student population beginning in the 2022-2023 school year.

- *Offered by Member Sharon Hays, Member Mea Mustone and Member Jenny Graham*

Sharon Hays: This is an effort going into the budget season to address what we have and what we might need. Looking for titles of staff and what services they provide.

Melanie McLaughlin: I am curious about non-IEP referrals for School based counseling.

Sharon Hays: I know that as a former special education teacher, that students on an IEP have it written in and I want to make sure that we have the staff to accommodate all who need the service.

Melanie McLaughlin: As far as requesting reports, is there not a process in place for requesting reports?

Jenny Graham: The first step is for the member to lay out what the request is which is what this does? If the superintendent needs to come back to us, it cannot happen until we take a vote.

Melanie McLaughlin: I am fine with taking the vote but am not sure if we are following the policy. Perhaps the Superintendent can get back to us with a time that works for delivering the report.

Paul Ruseau; Melanie is correct regarding the policy but the policy is that the Supt. would take an assessment of effort and get back to us with feasibility. There is nothing wrong with it as written but it should not take a week of work for someone. We should vote once we know that.

Supt. Edouard-Vincent: Can I ask Joan Bowen to come forward. Does March 7 seem feasible?

Joan Bowen: It is probably doable but we do need to speak to Stacey Schulman as well. I do anticipate that mid march would be fine.

Motion to approve: Sharon Hays/Mea Mustone as amended to mid March.

7/0 paper passes

8. Whereas the Medford School Committee has contemplated the creation and deployment of a vision committee to ascertain and articulate the Medford community's priorities and vision for Medford High School since 2019; and

Whereas Medford High School is a comprehensive high school serving approximately 1300 young adults of the Medford community charged with providing them with an engaging, well-rounded and culminating educational experience of their preK - 12+ academic careers and therefore serves as the flagship educational institution in which all members of the Medford community have a vested interest in its continuous improvement as a school; and

Whereas the establishment of the Medford High School vision committee has been delayed due to the ongoing challenges of the COVID-19 pandemic; and

Whereas the Medford School Committee recognizes that the deteriorating infrastructure of the current Medford High School demands urgent and bold action to ensure that current and future MHS students attend school in a building that is reflective of the Medford community's deep and abiding commitment to education; and

Whereas the students of Medford High School are entitled to a 21st century education that is empowered through the utilization of best-in-class instructional technology and innovative practices; and

Whereas the Medford Public Schools are wholly committed to ensuring an equitable and inclusive process by which community representatives can deliberate over how to develop a vision that will ensure a flagship school that leaves Medford High School graduates poised for post-secondary life defined by happiness, success, and fulfillment; and

Whereas effective January 28, 2022 the Massachusetts School Building Authority (MSBA) will open both the Core Program and Accelerated Repair Program Statement of Interest application windows;

Therefore be it resolved that the Superintendent of Schools, utilizing an inclusive and equitable process by which to formulate a recommendation, will present to the Medford School Committee on March 21, 2022 a recommended course of action with respect to the MSBA sanctioned repair, rehabilitation, and/or rebuild processes.

Be it further resolved that as part of the Superintendent's presentation, the central administration will report on the deliberative process by which the recommendation to pursue either, both, or neither of the MSBA programs was established, including the stakeholders who were consulted,

the school construction experts who were consulted, and the consensus if any about the strategic implications for the recommended course of action that developed through that process.

Be it further resolved that upon the Superintendent's recommendation, the Medford School Committee will convene, pursuant to School Committee Policy BDF, a Flagship Committee (formerly called the Medford High Vision Committee) comprised of representative stakeholders to deliberate over and make formal recommendations to the Medford School Committee about the organizing principles and core values that should be reflected in the district's flagship school regardless of whether the ultimate resolution to the MSBA application process is a new, refurbished, or extensively repaired Medford High School.

And be it further resolved that the Flagship Committee will convene to begin its work no later than April 4, 2022 and shall make progress reports to the Medford School Committee on a monthly basis for the duration of the term established when the Flagship Committee is formed.

- *Offered by Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn, Member Paul Ruseau, and Member Jenny Graham*

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: This is something we want everyone to support. We hope to have a unanimous collaboration with the city council to move this forward as well.

Melanie McLaughlin: Will there be clarification as to how we will build the committee. How will we ensure that members feel included in the process.

Jenny: This is written to adhere to our policy BEDF about forming task forces. That is what we will need to do before April 4. That is on us according to our policy. We will have to meet as a COW to form that committee.

Melanie McLaughlin: There is nothing written into it about the formation. I see our seven members and I am very concerned about the formation.

Kathy Kreatz: Is the flagship cte going to make the choice between a new school and a refurbished one or making academic decisions?

Jenny Graham: Will the committee decide that? No. MSBA will do that for us. Goal is to make sure we don't miss the window of opportunity with MSBA. Last time, there was no scope prepared before the group started meeting. Goal is to let the MSBA process lead us in that direction. Timing MSBA first, flagship committee second.

Kathy Kreatz: The cte will receive the statements of interest and work from there.

Jenny Graham: Motion to approve/Mea Mustone

Roll: Jenny Graham/Sharon Hays/Kathy Kreatz/Melanie McLaughlin/Mea Mustone/Paul Ruseau/Mayor Lungo-Koehn 7 yes/0 negative

Next Meeting

- **Monday, February 7, 2022: Regular School Committee Meeting - Alden Memorial**
Chambers, Medford City Hall in addition to zoom: <https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/j/95139729431>

Adjournment: 7/0 meeting adjourned at 10:11